



Nevada Pre-Kindergarten Social Emotional Standards, Revised 2025

**Building a Foundation for School
Readiness and Success in
PreK-12 and Beyond**



Social Emotional Learning (SEL) is the ongoing process of developing skills to understand and manage emotions, make thoughtful decisions, and sustain meaningful relationships. Throughout our lives we continually strengthen our social and emotional skills through interactions and relationships with others and by reflecting on our lived experiences. Families lay the foundation for their children's social and emotional development and educators complement this by teaching, modeling, and providing developmentally appropriate opportunities to practice these skills at school. Grounded in the widely recognized Collaborative for Academic, Social and Emotional Learning (CASEL) framework, the Nevada Pre-K Social Emotional Standards focus on the development and practice of five core competencies: 1) Self-Awareness; 2) Self-Management; 3) Social Awareness; 4) Relationship Skills; and 5) Responsible Decision Making. The CASEL Framework integrates SEL across classrooms, schools, families, and communities.

Social Emotional is the essential standard in Pre-K and should be integrated into all aspects of learning and development including daily routines and interactions. Young children develop foundational SE skills through play as they learn to express feelings and negotiate conflict. Early childhood practitioners support children's skill development through modeling and teaching emotional regulation strategies. To create a safe and supportive environment, teachers encourage children to explore their emotions, learn to recognize others' feelings, make independent choices and learn from mistakes.

Social emotional standards differ fundamentally from academic benchmarks, serving as a tool to raise awareness of lifelong social and emotional development. The SE standards should be used to inform instructional planning aligned with developmentally appropriate practices (DAP). The SE standards support DAP and are not intended as rigid achievement metrics, or a means to label or pathologize children. Remember, social and emotional skills develop uniquely for each individual.

The Social Emotional Standards include:

- **Social Emotional Standard 1:**
Develop self-awareness
- **Social Emotional Standard 2:**
Develop self-management
- **Social Emotional Standard 3:**
Develop social awareness
- **Social Emotional Standard 4:**
Develop relationship skills
- **Social Emotional Standard 5:**
Practice responsible decision making



Social Emotional Standards & Indicators PreK - Grade 12

Social Emotional Learning is the ongoing process of developing skills to understand and manage emotions, make thoughtful decisions, and sustain meaningful relationships.

Competencies

Indicator

Self-Awareness

The abilities to understand your own emotions, thoughts, and values, and how they influence your behavior across contexts. This includes the capacities to recognize your strengths and opportunities for growth.

- **Develop personal interests and self-efficacy**
- **Identify emotions**
- **Cultivate a growth mindset**

Self-Management

The abilities to understand and respond to your emotions and thoughts in different situations. This includes the capacities to delay gratification, manage stress, and practice self-determination to accomplish personal and collective goals.

- **Regulate emotions**
- **Set and achieve goals**
- **Develop agency**

Social Awareness

The abilities to understand the perspectives of and empathize with others, across backgrounds, cultures, and contexts. This includes the capacities to feel compassion for others and understand social norms for behavior in different settings.

- **Recognize the emotions and perspectives of others**
- **Demonstrate empathy and compassion**
- **Practice gratitude**

Relationship Skills

The abilities to establish and maintain healthy, supportive relationships. This includes the capacities to communicate clearly, listen actively, cooperate, work collaboratively to problem solve, negotiate conflict constructively, provide leadership, and seek or offer help when needed.

- **Communicate effectively**
- **Practice teamwork and collaborative problem-solving**
- **Seek and offer support when needed**

Responsible Decision Making

The abilities to make caring and constructive choices about personal behavior and social interactions across a variety of situations. This includes the capacities to consider ethical standards, evaluate safety and weigh the consequences of your actions.

- **Cultivate curiosity and open-mindedness**
- **Make reasoned decisions and judgments**
- **Understand the impact of your actions**

Social Emotional Key Terms

Self-Awareness

Self-efficacy is confidence in your ability to reach your goals.

Emotions are physiological reactions to something real or imagined around you (a racing heart, knot in your stomach, or sudden burst of energy) that affect your thoughts and behavior. **Feelings** are how you personally experience emotions.

Growth mindset is the belief that you can develop and improve your abilities by practicing, taking on challenges, and learning from mistakes.

Social Awareness

Perspective taking is the ability to consider and understand another person's point of view – their thoughts, feelings, and experiences – even if you don't share them.

Empathy is the capability to understand and share the feelings of others. **Compassion** is a caring response to another's suffering.

Gratitude is a sense of joy and thankfulness in recognition of something you see as good, which can be enhanced with awareness and practice.

Responsible Decision Making

Curiosity is a desire to know or learn something. **Open-mindedness** is a willingness to reserve judgment while considering new ideas.

Reasoning is a form of thinking that uses logic and existing knowledge to draw conclusions, solve problems or make decisions; it requires asking questions, thinking critically, and identifying patterns. **A reasoned decision or judgment** is a conclusion reached after gathering, analyzing, and evaluating information.

Understanding the impact of your actions means you consider how your choices and behavior might affect both you and others.

Self-Management

Regulating emotions is the act of pausing, noticing, and paying attention to the feelings in your body, then deciding how you want to feel and using strategies to get there.

Goal setting involves setting clear, achievable goals, figuring out the steps to reach them, and tracking your progress.

Agency is the freedom to make choices, develop ownership and take intentional actions.

Relationship Skills

Communication is the exchange of information, ideas, and feelings between people.

Teamwork is the united effort of a group to achieve a common goal.

Collaborative problem solving is the process of collaborating to explore and implement solutions, this includes listening to one another, assigning tasks, communicating, and implementing a plan.

Seeking support requires you to recognize and express a need or desire for help or emotional connection. **Offering support** requires you to recognize and respond to someone else's needs or wants.

Social Emotional Standard 1:**Develop self-awareness**

Self-Awareness Indicators	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SEL.SA.PK1 Develop personal interests and Self-efficacy	Share a dance, song, game, or other interest or talent with a friend or teacher. Point out/ask questions about something they find interesting (e.g., “what’s that?”). Spend more time in certain exploration centers based on interests. Indicate their preference by looking at, pointing to, or naming a play area when asked where they would like to play. Follow a daily routine (e.g. clean up, put blankets away) without being asked. Demonstrate self-help skills (e.g., put blocks away, pour juice).	• Engage children in conversation about their interests and experiences.* • Provide children the choice to participate in a variety of centers or activities. • Encourage children to practice self-help skills independently (e.g., put blocks away, pour juice). • Incorporate tools for emotional awareness throughout the classroom (e.g., sensory items, mirrors, pictures of facial expressions, emotion balls, feelings dolls). • Teach and model a range of vocabulary to help children label emotions.* • Teach children that everyone feels emotions - and no emotions are bad - they simply give us information about how our bodies are responding to an experience.
SEL.SA.PK2 Identify emotions	Communicate, with support, how an emotion feels in their bodies (e.g., a racing heart, change in breathing, knot in tummy). Identify a range of emotions (e.g., sadness, anger, fear, happiness, disgust). Use facial expressions, body language, or pretend play to act out emotions and feelings. Match pictures to emotions. Ask about and/or describe how a character feels in a story and why. Tell a friend or teacher how they feel and why.	• Prompt students to reflect on and communicate how their bodies feel when they experience different emotions (e.g., “how does your body feel when you’re angry?”) • Use check-ins and/or class meetings to provide opportunities for children to reflect on their feelings. • Model and teach strategies for emotional awareness by openly narrating your own thoughts, feelings, and actions throughout the day.*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Social Emotional Standard 1:**Develop self-awareness**

Self-Awareness Indicators	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SEL.SA.PK3 Cultivate a growth mindset	Clap, celebrate, high five, and/or exclaim “hey you did it!” “I tried!” “I can’t do this yet,” to acknowledge their own effort and/or the effort of others. Re-engage in a task or activity after experiencing success or disappointment. Try new activities and experiences with support from an adult or peer. For a short time, keep trying to finish a task that they are having difficulty with (e.g., continue to build a block structure when the blocks keep falling off, carry or move something awkward). Ask peers or adults for help to complete a task they are having difficulty with.	• Acknowledge effort and progress over outcomes.* • Encourage children to be creative in their own ways without providing “perfect” models. Focus on the process, not the product. • Support children’s confidence and bravery by allowing them to take risks and learn from mistakes.* • Help children reframe negative thoughts about themselves.* • Encourage students to try things on their own before providing help.* • Model a growth mindset by acknowledging your mistakes. • Create safe, predictable, supportive learning environments.* • Challenge students to try things that may be difficult at first and reflect on progress over time.

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Social Emotional Standard 2: Develop self-management

Self-Management Indicators	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SEL.SM.PK1 Regulate emotions	Acknowledge and express emotions verbally and/or non-verbally (e.g., smile, stomp, say “I’m sad,” and/or “I’m happy”). Identify the cause(s) of a particular feeling, (e.g., point/gesture and/or say, “I’m excited it’s my birthday!” “They won’t let me play and I’m sad”). Pause to breathe and/or engage in physical exercise when noticing a big feeling in the body, with support. Go to a specific area of the classroom (e.g., calm down area) to grab a sensory item, use a tool and/or practice a strategy they’ve been taught. Communicate with a peer or adult to express the cause of their emotions and ask for support. Choose a new activity, talk with a friend, or engage in physical play to redirect attention away from the cause of an unhelpful emotion, with support. Take a break from an activity when feeling frustrated or over-excited, with prompting from an adult or peer.	• Approach children’s emotions with curiosity rather than judgment - avoid making assumptions about how a child feels, why they feel that way, or what behavior may follow.* • Validate children’s emotions and experiences, (e.g., “that would make me upset too,” “that IS really exciting!”.* • Support children in moving through unhelpful emotions by using strategies to reduce the intensity of a feeling, and/or to redirect attention to something else. • Teach and practice breathing strategies (e.g., star breathing, balloon breathing, birthday candles, smell the flower). • Provide calming spaces, sensory bins, feelings wall, or other means to support regulation in response to children’s emotional and/or physiological needs. • Teach students to use regulation/calming strategies and model these strategies for them throughout the day by narrating your own regulation actions. • Redirect a child’s attention and/or thoughts away from the cause of an unhelpful emotion by offering a new activity or engaging them in conversation or physical play.* • Help children link thoughts and emotions through reflecting on prior experiences.

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.

Social Emotional Standard 2: Develop self-management

Self-Management Indicators	Examples: Children will/may...	Supportive Practices: Teachers/Practitioners will...
SEL.SM.PK2 Set and achieve goals	Express a desire to achieve something (e.g., say, “I want to write my name,” or gesture to the height they want to build a structure). Explore a step-by-step process, with support, to achieve a goal (e.g., learn to write a word, or put on and zip up a coat). Track their progress toward a group goal (e.g. check off an activity on a visual schedule). Try a new way to reach a goal after experiencing failure or success. Express satisfaction when accomplishing a task (e.g., say, “I/we did it!” clap, or high-five).	• Break down tasks into achievable steps* • Encourage children to review progress toward a goal and notice how much closer they are (e.g., “You started your zipper by yourself!). • Set and revisit intentions throughout the day. • Encourage children to work with peers to achieve goals. • Provide exploration centers and use choice boards/picture cards to allow children to select where they would like to play. • Establish predictable routines and adhere to a daily schedule that includes opportunities for children to make their own choices.*
SEL.SM.PK3 Develop agency	Indicate their choice of play area by pointing to or naming it when asked where they want to play. Move through routines and activities with minimal adult direction (e.g., follow daily schedules and perform jobs). Initiate play with others or join in play with a group. Choose to engage in cooperative centers or work individually on a task. Communicate choices/preferences (e.g., request colors for painting, ask to open a center).	• Use a visual schedule and encourage children to check off activities as they move through the day. • Encourage and support children to join in play with others. • Be responsive to requests from children, (e.g., open centers and/or get out supplies for a particular activity when a child asks).*

* This symbol indicates this practice can be used across other (or cross-curricular) domains.